

PASSWITHPURPOSE

NEW
2027
FORMAT

CAMBRIDGE IGCSE • FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH • 0500

Paper 2

Directed Writing

Four complete Section A tasks for the new 2027 exam, covering the 1(a) structured question and 1(b) directed writing, with model answers for a speech, a letter, an article and a report.

- ◆ 4 full Section A tasks (160 marks)
- ◆ New 1(a) evaluation questions
- ◆ 4 annotated model answers
- ◆ Planning frame & form toolkit
- ◆ 6 original source texts
- ◆ 1(b) in all four forms
- ◆ Mark schemes & indicative content
- ◆ Evaluation phrase bank

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For exams in 2027, 2028 and 2029. Independent practice material; not produced or endorsed by Cambridge University Press & Assessment. All texts are original.

How to use this pack

From June 2027, Section A of Cambridge IGCSE First Language English (0500) Paper 2 gives candidates one or two texts (about 550–650 words in total) and two linked questions. This pack gives you four complete tasks in that format, one for each form candidates may be asked to write.

Question	What candidates do	Marks
1(a)	Short structured answers: analyse and evaluate the ideas in the text(s), including how the writer tries to influence readers	5
1(b)	Directed writing: a speech, letter, article or report of 250–350 words that uses, develops and evaluates the ideas in the text(s)	35 10 R + 25 W

The four tasks

Task 1	Phones in Schools	Two texts	Speech
Task 2	Paying for Paradise	One text	Letter
Task 3	Compulsory School Sport	Two texts	Article
Task 4	The Future of the Library	One text	Report

The five-step method for 1(b)

1 Decode	Circle the form, audience, purpose and the position you will take.
2 Map	List every argument in the text(s). Mark each one: agree, disagree or “yes, but...”.
3 Evaluate	Question the evidence: Is it reliable? Is it biased? What is missing? Do the texts contradict each other?
4 Plan	Hook, three developed paragraphs drawn from the texts, a clear conclusion or call to action.
5 Write & check	250–350 words in the right form and register. Leave time to proofread.

Timed practice

Print the insert and question paper. Allow about one hour for Section A.

Teach the form

Study the model answer and its notes first, then set a different task in the same form.

Tutoring

Use Task 1 to diagnose, then work on the weakest strand: evaluation, form or accuracy.

Form toolkit & evaluation phrase bank

Form	Must include	Register
Speech	Greeting to the audience; a hook; signposting ("First... Finally..."); direct address and inclusive "we"; a memorable close and thanks	Engaging, rhetorical, suited to listeners
Letter	"Dear..."; purpose stated in the first paragraph; one main point per paragraph; polite request or call to action; "Yours sincerely/faithfully"	Formal to officials; warmer to people you know
Article	Headline (and optional subheading); an opening that grabs attention; lively paragraphs; a strong final line	Informative and lively; suited to the publication
Report	Title; "To/From" or purpose line; clear subheadings; balanced findings; numbered recommendations; conclusion	Objective, clear and formal; no emotive language

From repeating to evaluating

Repeating	"The text says visitor numbers have fallen by forty per cent."
Using	"Visitor numbers have fallen sharply, which worries the council."
Developing	"If fewer people visit, the library may struggle to justify its costs."
Evaluating	"However, opening hours were halved, so the fall may reflect closed doors rather than lost interest."

Evaluation phrase bank

Questioning evidence

- "This statistic proves less than it seems because..."
- "The writer relies on a single example..."
- "We are not told who carried out this research..."
- "This may be true for one school, but..."

Weighing arguments

- "The strongest point here is... because..."
- "This is a fair concern, but it is not a reason to..."
- "Both writers agree that...; they differ only on..."
- "A more balanced view would recognise that..."

Paper 2 Section A · Task 1: Phones in Schools

Section A · 40 marks · about 1 hour. Read both texts in the insert (about 600 words), then answer Question 1(a) and Question 1(b). Suggested timing: read and answer 1(a) 15 min · plan 1(b) 8 min · write 1(b) 35 min · check 2 min.

Question 1(a) 5 marks

- (i) Explain how the writer of Text 1 tries to persuade readers to support a phone ban. Refer to **two** examples from the text. [3]
- (ii) How convincing is the claim in Text 1 that the ban improved exam results? Give reasons for your answer. [2]

Question 1(b) 35 marks

Your school is considering banning mobile phones for the whole school day. You have been asked to give a speech to the school council, which is made up of students, teachers and parents. [35]

In your speech you should:

- evaluate the arguments for and against a full ban given in both texts
- give your own view, with reasons, about what the school should do.

Base your speech on what you have read in both texts, but be careful to use your own words. Address both bullet points. Write about **250 to 350 words**. Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 25 marks for the quality of your writing.

BEFORE YOU WRITE: Use the planning frame. Circle the form, audience and purpose, and mark each argument in the text: agree, disagree or “yes, but...”.